



Virtual makeup with AR
Sephora's iOS app gets new update with "Sephora Virtual Artist" that lets you try virtual makeup with AR. <http://dgit.in/MakeupAR>



OPM is coming to Netflix
One of the most popular anime series, One-Punch Man is now available for streaming through Netflix. <http://dgit.in/NetflixOPM>

Bazaar

Moto G5 Plus

Upping the ante

The fifth iteration of Motorola's Moto G series is perhaps the biggest upgrade these devices have ever received. The dual-pixel camera on the Moto G5 Plus sets new standards for budget cameras on the market. It's underscored by very high dynamic range, attaining high contrast in photos and warm colours when shooting in regular daylight conditions. It manages exposure well for a budget device and takes good low light photos.

Quite surprisingly though, the Moto G5 Plus has a slow camera. Focusing speeds are reasonable, but not as fast as you would expect from a dual-pixel camera. It has the same camera specs as the Galaxy S7, with a f/1.7 aperture and 1.4 micron pixel size. However, this doesn't seem like the IMX260 sensor from Sony. Processing speeds are also higher and the camera takes longer to focus under low light, resulting in blurry shots often. As a result, it's not as dependable as you would want it to be.

Overall, the camera is underscored by pleasantly warm colours, high dynamic range and good exposure controls. The G5 also manages ISO levels quite well, keeping them between 50 to 80 in regular daylight conditions. You will see noise when zooming into photos, losing finer details in images but that would matter only to those looking to enlarge and print those photos. For sharing on social media, the Moto G5 Plus' camera is the best in the budget range.

Moving on, the G5 Plus runs on Qualcomm's Snapdragon 625 SoC, clocked at 2 GHz. All eight Cortex A53 cores are kept alive at all times, ramping up to 2 GHz whenever you launch heavy apps, like games. In practice, your phone won't freeze when launching apps like Asphalt 8 that usually take a split second more to open. Overall, performance is reasonably snappy, although, a Snapdragon 650 would have been preferred. For real world usage, there's really nothing worth complaining about, even though this isn't the fastest phone in this price range.

It maintains a steady 30 FPS while playing games like Asphalt 8, with 80% frame rate stability over half an hour. Internal temperatures never rose beyond 37 degrees.

Interestingly, despite the fact that all eight cores are kept on, the Moto G5 Plus manages an impressive battery life. Motorola chose a 3000



Price
₹16,999

mAh unit, which is low by current standards. Over a day's usage, the phone lasted us almost 24 hours on a single charge. That's considering two hours of audio recording, about half an hour spent playing Asphalt 8, quite a few photos taken, and about 20 odd phone calls. This includes 8 hours of idle time, where the phone dropped 5% battery.

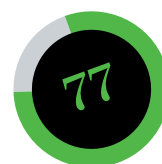
The phone lasted for 7 hours and 24 minutes on the PCMark Work 2.0 Battery test, while Gamebench shows over 5 hours of gameplay time. It seems Motorola has made the best use of the balance between performance and efficiency which the Snapdragon 625 provides.

Despite its fluidity and good camera, there are some shortcomings too. For one, the 5.2-inch LCD panel on the Moto G5 Plus isn't the brightest out there, and colours don't look punchy, due to low saturation. It's a functional display but not necessarily the most pleasant to look at. Sunlight visibility is average and Adaptive Display doesn't really do much to improve things either.

Further, the fact that Motorola is only selling 16 GB and 32 GB variants of the phone is disappointing. While 32 GB is still enough to work with, at ₹16,999, one should be looking at 64 GB storage nowadays. On the other hand, 16 GB is simply not enough for smartphone users any more, especially with apps like Netflix and Amazon Prime allowing you to download content onto your device.

Barring storage, the Moto G5 Plus is a really good smartphone. If the camera is your priority, the Moto G5 Plus is the phone you should pick.

Prasad Banerjee



Features75
Design77
Performance85
Value71

Specifications

Display: 5.2 inch FHD;
RAM: 3/4 GB; **ROM:** 16/32 GB; **Operating System:** Android Nougat;
SoC: 2 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 625; **Battery:** 3000 mAh; **Camera:** 12 MP dual-pixel rear camera, 5 MP front camera

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